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INTELLIGENT ACCESS CONTROL SYSTEM

Abstract

A method, by an intelligent access control system, of implementing access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point includes the following operations. A security token is generated. The security token is transmitted to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user, and the client module is caused to pair with an access control device associated with the first user. The client module is caused to transfer the security token to the access control device. A physical location of the client device within the controlled area is monitored. A determination is made, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated. The client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

[0001] The present invention relates to access control systems, and more specifically, to an intelligent access control system that leverages mobile devices and access control devices.

[0002] Many private areas have access control, in which certain individuals are limited as to the specific areas, whether inside and/or outside, the individual is allowed to travel. Access control systems are oftentimes used in these situations and can take the form of an access control device that allows the possessor of that access control device to unlock a particular access point (e.g., a door). The access control device and access points are controlled by an access control system that associates particular privileges (e.g., location access) to a particular individual via the individual's access control device.

[0003] In certain instances, such as when visitor enter a particular location being managed by an access control system, the visitor may receive a temporary access control device and/or be associated with an individual (e.g., a guide) who has their own access control device. Whether intentionally or not, visitors can generate undesirable security breaches to the area under access control. Consequently, there is a need to provide an improved access control system that better control and monitor granularity of access and presence without creating unnecessary obstacles to access.

SUMMARY

[0004] A method, by an intelligent access control system, of implementing access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point includes the following operations. A security token is generated. The security token is transmitted to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user, and the client module is caused to pair with an access control device associated with the first user. The client module is caused to transfer the security token to the access control device. A physical location of the client device within the controlled area is monitored. A determination is made, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated. The client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.

[0005] In other aspects, the process includes the security token being regenerated and transmitted to the client module based upon the access control device being used at one of the at least one access point. Also, the transmitting includes transmitting a policy associated with the controlled area to the client module. The determining can be based upon a second user with a second client device being at least a certain distance away from the first client device wherein the first user is a controlling user, and the second user is a controlled user. The determining can also be based upon a time in which the first user is within one of the plurality of access areas. The policy is based upon one of the plurality of access areas in which the first user is located. Additionally, the client module is configured to receive a request to opt into using the intelligent access control system.

[0006] An intelligent access control system configured to implement access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point includes a hardware processor configured to perform the following executable operations. A security token is generated. The security token is transmitted to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user, and the client module is caused to pair with an access control device associated with the first user. The client module is caused to transfer the security token to the access control device. A physical location of the client device within the controlled area is monitored. A determination is made, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated. The client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.

[0007] In other aspects, the intelligent access control system includes the security token being regenerated and transmitted to the client module based upon the access control device being used at one of the at least one access point. Also, the transmitting includes transmitting a policy associated

with the controlled area to the client module. The determining can be based upon a second user with a second client device being at least a certain distance away from the first client device wherein the first user is a controlling user, and the second user is a controlled user. The determining can also be based upon a time in which the first user is within one of the plurality of access areas. The policy is based upon one of the plurality of access areas in which the first user is located. Additionally, the client module is configured to receive a request to opt into using the intelligent access control system.

[0008] A computer program product includes a computer readable storage medium having stored therein program code for implementing access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point. The program code, which when executed by an intelligent access control system, cause the intelligent access control system to perform the following. A security token is generated. The security token is transmitted to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user, and the client module is caused to pair with an access control device associated with the first user. The client module is caused to transfer the security token to the access control device. A physical location of the client device within the controlled area is monitored. A determination is made, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated. The client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.

[0009] In other aspects, the computer program product includes the security token being regenerated and transmitted to the client module based upon the access control device being used at one of the at least one access point. Also, the transmitting includes transmitting a policy associated with the controlled area to the client module. The determining can be based upon a second user with a second client device being at least a certain distance away from the first client device wherein the first user is a controlling user, and the second user is a controlled user. The determining can also be based upon a time in which the first user is within one of the plurality of access areas. The policy is based upon one of the plurality of access areas in which the first user is located. Additionally, the client module is configured to receive a request to opt into using the intelligent access control system.

[0010] This Summary section is provided merely to introduce certain concepts and not to identify any key or essential features of the claimed subject matter. Other features of the inventive arrangements will be apparent from the accompanying drawings and from the following detailed description.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] FIG. 1A is a block diagram of an intelligent access system according to an aspect of the present invention.

[0012] FIG. 1B is a block diagram further illustrating the architecture of an access control device of FIG. 1A according to an aspect of the present invention.

[0013] FIG. 1C is a block diagram further illustrating the architecture of an client computer device of FIG. 1A according to an aspect of the present invention.

[0014] FIG. 2 illustrates a methodology of employing the intelligent access control system of FIG. 1B according to an aspect of the present invention.

[0015] FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an example of computer hardware system for implementing the intelligent access control system of FIG. 1A.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0016] Reference is made to FIGS. 1A-1C and 2, which respectively illustrate an intelligent access control system **100** and methodology **200** for implementing access control to a controlled area **120**

having a plurality access areas A-C divided by at least one access point **140**. The intelligent access control system **100** can include an access monitoring system **110**, one or more access control devices **116**, and a client module **135** executing on one or more mobile client devices **134**.

[0017] Referring to FIG. **1B**, many types of access control devices **116** are currently known, and the access control device (ACD) **116** of the intelligent access control system **110** is not limited to a particular type of access control device **116**. Example types of access control devices **116** include, for example, contactless cards and magnetic strip cards. While the access control device **116** communicates with mobile client device **134** using a communication module **117**, the access control device **116** is not limited in the manner in which the access control device **116** communicates with the mobile client device **134** using the communication module **117**.

[0018] Additionally, the access control device **115** includes storage **119** into which data (e.g., a security token in the form of an unique identification number) received from the mobile client device **134** can be stored.

[0019] Referring to FIG. **1C**, the mobile client device **134** is not limited as to a particular type of mobile client device **134**. However, the mobile client device **134** should be capable of being transported (e.g., handheld) by the user **130**. Exemplary types of mobile client devices **134** include mobile phones, smart watches, and tablets. The mobile client device **134** also includes a client module **135** associated with the access monitoring system **110**. The client module **135** may be a module that already exists on the mobile client device **134** (e.g., such as a native browser that interacts with a server associated with the access monitoring system **110**) and/or the client module **135** can be a specialized module that is downloaded onto the mobile client device **134** (e.g., such as a downloadable app).

[0020] Additionally, the client module **135** is configured to communicate with the access monitoring system **110** and the access control device **115**. The manner in which the client module **135**, operating on the mobile client device **134**, communicates with the access monitoring system **110** and the access control device **115** is not limited in a particular manner. Moreover, the client module **135**, operating on the mobile client device **134**, can communicate with the access monitoring system **110** using a different approach than the client module **135** communicates with the access control device **115**. Illustrative examples of different communication approaches include near-field communication (e.g., RFID), Bluetooth, and Wi-Fi.

[0021] Referring specifically to FIGS. **1A** and **2**, the process **200** of employing the intelligent access control system **100** involves, in **210**, a user **130** opting-in using the intelligent access control system **100**. This can include the user **130** loading/executing a client module **135** on the mobile client device **134** associated with the user **130**. Referring to FIG. **1A**, although the present disclosure is discussed with regard to a single user **130**, multiple users **130A-C** can each have their own mobile client device and their own access control device **115** (not illustrated). The access control devices associated with each of these multiple users **130A-C** can be tied to (as controlled access control devices) one or more controlling access control devices (e.g., access control device **130**) having different permission levels. By way of example, the controlling access control device **134** could be associated with a tour guide user **130** whereas the controlled access control devices could be associated with visitor users **130A-C**.

[0022] In **220**, once the client module **135** is operational, the client module **135** is configured to interact with the access monitoring system **110**. Although not limited in this manner, a session can be established between the client module **135** and the access monitoring system **110** for a predetermined period of time and/or while the user is within the confines of the controlled area **120**. Once communication between the client module **135** and the access monitoring system **110** is established, the client module **135** can receive, from the access monitoring system **110**, any specific policies associated with the controlled area **120**. These policies, for example, can define rules as to how the user **130** is to access certain of Access Areas A-D and/or whether the user **130** can access certain portions of the controlled area **120**. Additionally, the client module **135** can be configured to

allow the user **130** to set preferences as to how the user **130** is to receive notifications from the accessing monitoring system **110** via the client module **135**. For example, a preference may to receive an audible notification and/or a tactile notification (e.g., vibration).

[0023] Additionally, the client module **135** can receive a security token in the form of an unique identification (ID) number from the access monitoring system **110** that can be shared by the client module **135**, via the client device **134**, with the access control device **115**. The unique ID number can then be stored by the access control device **115** within storage **119**. Since the unique ID number is known by the client module **135**, the unique ID number can be used to tie a particular client device **134** to a particular access control device **115**. In this manner, a user **130** associated with the particular client device **134** can be tied to the particular access control device **115**.

[0024] In **230**, the client module **135**, via the mobile client device **134**, is configured to pair with access control device **115**. The pairing acts to initiate a communication link between the mobile client device **134** and the access control device **115**. This communication link can be periodic, intermittent (e.g., as needed), or substantially continuous. This communication link (i.e., heartbeat **133**) can establish that a defined physical proximity exists between the mobile client device **134** and the access control device **115**. Operation **230**, although depicted as being performed following operation **220**, can be performed at the same time (or prior to) operation **220**.

[0025] In **240**, the physical location of the mobile client device **134** (as the user **130** moves through the through the controlled area **120**) is monitored by the access monitoring system **110**, and the location of the mobile client device **134** acts as a proxy for the location of the user **134**. Many different approaches are known capable of determining the location of a particular mobile client device **134** and the intelligent access control system **100** is not limited as to a particular approach so capable. For example, many types of mobile client devices **134** include global position systems (GPS) and the mobile client device **134** can communicate the real-time GPS location of the mobile client device **134** to the access monitoring system **110**.

[0026] As another example, mobile client devices **134** oftentimes include transmitters that constantly produce signals using Bluetooth, WIFI, and/or LTE bands. The access control system **110** can connect with communication nodes **150** associated with the controlled area **120** and are configured to detect these signals. WIFI and Bluetooth-emitted signal strengths can be typically measured using decibel milliwatts (dBm), a unit used to indicate the power ratio of decibels (dB) with reference to one milliwatt (mW) using the Received Signal Strength Indicator (RSSI). Employing this technique, a distance between a particular communication node **150** and a particular client device **134** can be determined. Through the use of multiple communication nodes **150**, an approximate location of the particular client device **134** within the controlled area **120** can be determined.

[0027] In **250**, a determination is made whether to revalidate the user **130**. This determination can be made by the access monitoring system **110**, the client module **135**, or a combination of both. The basis by which revalidation is determined to be necessary can vary. Revalidation may be based upon a particular location of the user. For example, based upon the location information determined in **240**, the user **130** may have entered a restricted area. Alternatively, a controlled user **130A** may have wandered too far away from a controlling user **130**. In an another example, the revalidation may be based upon time. For example, revalidation may occur after a particular amount of time (e.g., a tour the last 2 hours may require revalidation after 2 hours and 15 minutes) or during a preset period of time (e.g., a sensitive area may be viewed during after-hours). Although not limited in this manner, the basis can be associated with the policy loaded from the accessing monitoring system **110** into the client module **135**.

[0028] In **260**, once a determination has been made that revalidation is needed, the client module **135** of the mobile client device **134** is configured to prompt the user **130** for additional security measures (i.e., revalidation). If the access monitoring system **110** performs the determination, the access monitoring system **110** can communicate with the client module **135** of the mobile client

device **134** to perform the prompting. The manner in which the user **130** is prompted is not limited as to a particular approach and can be controlled by the policy. For example, the mobile client device **134** can issue an audio or tactile alert. In addition to (or alternatively), the prompt can take the form of a visual alert on the mobile client device **134** (such as a pop-up window). Additionally, depending upon the determination, the user **130** may be directed to a security location (e.g., an access point **140**, security camera **152**, or security desk **160**) or if the user is a controlled user **130A** (e.g., visitor), the controlled user **130A** may be directed to check in with the controlling user **130A** (e.g., tour guide).

[0029] In **270**, the user **130** is validated, which involves the user **130** being physically present at a security location (e.g., an access point **140**, security camera **152**, or security desk **160**) or a controlled user **130A** checking in with the controlling user **130A**. The manner in which the user **130** is validated can vary and is not limited to a particular approach. For example, the user **130** may be required to present the access control card **134** at an access point **140**, or allow the user's image to be scanned by the security camera **152**, or have the user's identification be confirmed (e.g., visually, electronically, physically such as a thumbprint) at a security desk **160**. Regardless of the approach, the revalidation of the user **130** is a security check that reestablishes the identity and/or current location of the user **130** to the access monitoring system **110**.

[0030] In **280**, a determination is made whether the user **130** uses the access control card **134** to check into one of the access points **140**. Using an access control card **134** to check into an access point **140** is a known technology, and the access control system **110** is not limited as to any particularly technology so capable. At the time of the access control device **116** being used at an access point **140**, the access control system **110** can confirm that the security token stored within the storage **119** of the access control device **110** matches the security token associated with the user **130** (e.g., by comparing the security token contained within the mobile client device **134** that is associated with the user **130**). If the user **130** does not encounter an access point **140**, the process **200** loops back to **240** to monitor a location of the client device **134**.

[0031] In **290**, after the access control card **134** has accessed one of the access points **140**, in **280**, the access control system **110** can optionally generate a new security token and forward the security token to the mobile client device **134**. The access control system **110** can also forward, to the client module **135** of the mobile client device **134**, a specific policy associated with the access area within the controlled area **120** being accessed by the user **130**. For example, as the user **130** moves from access area A to access area B through the access point **140** between these two access areas A, B, then a policy associated with access area B can be provided to the client module **135**. The operations of **290** can also occur after/during the revalidation of the user in operation **270**.

[0032] In **295**, the client module **135**, via the client device **134**, communicates the new security token to the access control device **115**, and the access control device **115** can cause the old security token stored within storage **119** to be overwritten. Additionally, the client module **135** can use the new policy associated with the new access area. For example, the client module **135** can use the new policy to alert the user of any particular security requirements (e.g., to physically check in at a particular location or inform the user of restricted hours for that location such as a user cannot be present in the new access area from the hours of 9:00 PM to 6:00 AM). The new policy can be used, for example, to present the user with a map of the new access area that would not have been otherwise been made available. The policy can also be used to establish, in instances where there is a controlling user **130** and controlled users **130A-C**, that a controlled user **130A** (e.g., a visitor) is required to be within a predetermined distance from the controlling user **130** (e.g., the guide), and this predetermined distance can vary depending upon the particular access area.

[0033] Once the new security token has been stored within the storage **119** of the access control device **115**, the process **200** loops back to **240** to monitor a location of the client device **134**.

[0034] As defined herein, the term “responsive to” means responding or reacting readily to an action or event. Thus, if a second action is performed “responsive to” a first action, there is a causal

relationship between an occurrence of the first action and an occurrence of the second action, and the term “responsive to” indicates such causal relationship.

[0035] As defined herein, the term “real time” means a level of processing responsiveness that a user or system senses as sufficiently immediate for a particular process or determination to be made, or that enables the processor to keep up with some external process.

[0036] As defined herein, the term “automatically” means without user intervention.

[0037] Referring to FIG. 3, computing environment **300** contains an example of an environment for the execution of at least some of the computer code involved in performing the inventive methods, such as code block **350** for implementing the operations of the access monitoring system **110** and the client module **135**. Computing environment **300** includes, for example, computer **301**, wide area network (WAN) **302**, end user device (EUD) **303**, remote server **304**, public cloud **305**, and private cloud **306**. In certain aspects, computer **301** includes processor set **310** (including processing circuitry **320** and cache **321**), communication fabric **311**, volatile memory **312**, persistent storage **313** (including operating system **322** and method code block **350**), peripheral device set **314** (including user interface (UI), device set **323**, storage **324**, and Internet of Things (IoT) sensor set **325**), and network module **315**. Remote server **304** includes remote database **330**. Public cloud **305** includes gateway **340**, cloud orchestration module **341**, host physical machine set **342**, virtual machine set **343**, and container set **344**.

[0038] Computer **301** may take the form of a desktop computer, laptop computer, tablet computer, smart phone, smart watch or other wearable computer, mainframe computer, quantum computer or any other form of computer or mobile device now known or to be developed in the future that is capable of running a program, accessing a network or querying a database, such as remote database **330**. As is well understood in the art of computer technology, and depending upon the technology, performance of a computer-implemented method may be distributed among multiple computers and/or between multiple locations. However, to simplify this presentation of computing environment **300**, detailed discussion is focused on a single computer, specifically computer **301**. Computer **301** may or may not be located in a cloud, even though it is not shown in a cloud in FIG. 3 except to any extent as may be affirmatively indicated.

[0039] Processor set **310** includes one, or more, computer processors of any type now known or to be developed in the future. As defined herein, the term “processor” means at least one hardware circuit (e.g., an integrated circuit) configured to carry out instructions contained in program code. Examples of a processor include, but are not limited to, a central processing unit (CPU), an array processor, a vector processor, a digital signal processor (DSP), a field-programmable gate array (FPGA), a programmable logic array (PLA), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), programmable logic circuitry, and a controller. Processing circuitry **320** may be distributed over multiple packages, for example, multiple, coordinated integrated circuit chips. Processing circuitry **320** may implement multiple processor threads and/or multiple processor cores. Cache **321** is memory that is located in the processor chip package(s) and is typically used for data or code that should be available for rapid access by the threads or cores running on processor set **310**. Cache memories are typically organized into multiple levels depending upon relative proximity to the processing circuitry. Alternatively, some, or all, of the cache for the processor set may be located “off chip.” In certain computing environments, processor set **310** may be designed for working with qubits and performing quantum computing.

[0040] Computer readable program instructions are typically loaded onto computer **301** to cause a series of operational steps to be performed by processor set **310** of computer **301** and thereby effect a computer-implemented method, such that the instructions thus executed will instantiate the methods specified in flowcharts and/or narrative descriptions of computer-implemented methods discussed above in this document (collectively referred to as “the inventive methods”). These computer readable program instructions are stored in various types of computer readable storage media, such as cache **321** and the other storage media discussed below. The program instructions,

and associated data, are accessed by processor set **310** to control and direct performance of the inventive methods. In computing environment **300**, at least some of the instructions for performing the inventive methods may be stored in code block **350** in persistent storage **313**.

[0041] A computer program product embodiment (“CPP embodiment” or “CPP”) is a term used in the present disclosure to describe any set of one, or more, storage media (also called “mediums”) collectively included in a set of one, or more, storage devices that collectively include machine readable code corresponding to instructions and/or data for performing computer operations specified in a given CPP claim. A “storage device” is any tangible, hardware device that can retain and store instructions for use by a computer processor. Without limitation, the computer readable storage medium may be an electronic storage medium, a magnetic storage medium, an optical storage medium, an electromagnetic storage medium, a semiconductor storage medium, a mechanical storage medium, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. Some known types of storage devices that include these mediums include: diskette, hard disk, random access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), static random access memory (SRAM), compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disk (DVD), memory stick, floppy disk, mechanically encoded device (such as punch cards or pits/lands formed in a major surface of a disc) or any suitable combination of the foregoing.

[0042] A computer readable storage medium, as that term is used in the present disclosure, is not to be construed as storage in the form of transitory signals per se, such as radio waves or other freely propagating electromagnetic waves, electromagnetic waves propagating through a waveguide, light pulses passing through a fiber optic cable, electrical signals communicated through a wire, and/or other transmission media. As will be understood by those of skill in the art, data is typically moved at some occasional points in time during normal operations of a storage device, such as during access, de-fragmentation or garbage collection, but this does not render the storage device as transitory because the data is not transitory while it is stored.

[0043] Communication fabric **311** is the signal conduction paths that allow the various components of computer **301** to communicate with each other. Typically, this communication fabric **311** is made of switches and electrically conductive paths, such as the switches and electrically conductive paths that make up busses, bridges, physical input/output ports and the like. Other types of signal communication paths may be used for the communication fabric **311**, such as fiber optic communication paths and/or wireless communication paths.

[0044] Volatile memory **312** is any type of volatile memory now known or to be developed in the future. Examples include dynamic type random access memory (RAM) or static type RAM. Typically, the volatile memory **312** is characterized by random access, but this is not required unless affirmatively indicated. In computer **301**, the volatile memory **312** is located in a single package and is internal to computer **301**. In addition to alternatively, the volatile memory **312** may be distributed over multiple packages and/or located externally with respect to computer **301**.

[0045] Persistent storage **313** is any form of non-volatile storage for computers that is now known or to be developed in the future. The non-volatility of the persistent storage **313** means that the stored data is maintained regardless of whether power is being supplied to computer **301** and/or directly to persistent storage **313**. Persistent storage **313** may be a read only memory (ROM), but typically at least a portion of the persistent storage **313** allows writing of data, deletion of data and re-writing of data. Some familiar forms of persistent storage **313** include magnetic disks and solid state storage devices. Operating system **322** may take several forms, such as various known proprietary operating systems or open source Portable Operating System Interface type operating systems that employ a kernel. The code included in code block **350** typically includes at least some of the computer code involved in performing the inventive methods.

[0046] Peripheral device set **314** includes the set of peripheral devices for computer **301**. Data communication connections between the peripheral devices and the other components of computer

301 may be implemented in various ways, such as Bluetooth connections, Near-Field Communication (NFC) connections, connections made by cables (such as universal serial bus (USB) type cables), insertion type connections (for example, secure digital (SD) card), connections made through local area communication networks and even connections made through wide area networks such as the internet.

[0047] In various aspects, UI device set **323** may include components such as a display screen, speaker, microphone, wearable devices (such as goggles and smart watches), keyboard, mouse, printer, touchpad, game controllers, and haptic devices. Storage **324** is external storage, such as an external hard drive, or insertable storage, such as an SD card. Storage **324** may be persistent and/or volatile. In some aspects, storage **324** may take the form of a quantum computing storage device for storing data in the form of qubits. In aspects where computer **301** is required to have a large amount of storage (for example, where computer **301** locally stores and manages a large database) then this storage **324** may be provided by peripheral storage devices designed for storing very large amounts of data, such as a storage area network (SAN) that is shared by multiple, geographically distributed computers. Internet-of-Things (IoT) sensor set **325** is made up of sensors that can be used in IoT applications. For example, one sensor may be a thermometer and another sensor may be a motion detector.

[0048] Network module **315** is the collection of computer software, hardware, and firmware that allows computer **301** to communicate with other computers through a Wide Area Network (WAN) **302**. Network module **315** may include hardware, such as modems or Wi-Fi signal transceivers, software for packetizing and/or de-packetizing data for communication network transmission, and/or web browser software for communicating data over the internet. In certain aspects, network control functions and network forwarding functions of network module **315** are performed on the same physical hardware device. In other aspects (for example, aspects that utilize software-defined networking (SDN)), the control functions and the forwarding functions of network module **315** are performed on physically separate devices, such that the control functions manage several different network hardware devices. Computer readable program instructions for performing the inventive methods can typically be downloaded to computer **301** from an external computer or external storage device through a network adapter card or network interface included in network module **315**.

[0049] WAN **302** is any Wide Area Network (for example, the internet) capable of communicating computer data over non-local distances by any technology for communicating computer data, now known or to be developed in the future. In some aspects, the WAN **302** may be replaced and/or supplemented by local area networks (LANs) designed to communicate data between devices located in a local area, such as a Wi-Fi network. The WAN **302** and/or LANs typically include computer hardware such as copper transmission cables, optical transmission fibers, wireless transmission, routers, firewalls, switches, gateway computers and edge servers.

[0050] End user device (EUD) **303** is any computer system that is used and controlled by an end user (for example, a customer of an enterprise that operates computer **301**), and may take any of the forms discussed above in connection with computer **301**. EUD **303** typically receives helpful and useful data from the operations of computer **301**. For example, in a hypothetical case where computer **301** is designed to provide a recommendation to an end user, this recommendation would typically be communicated from network module **315** of computer **301** through WAN **302** to EUD **303**. In this way, EUD **303** can display, or otherwise present, the recommendation to an end user. In certain aspects, EUD **303** may be a client device, such as thin client, heavy client, mainframe computer, desktop computer and so on.

[0051] As defined herein, the term “client device” means a data processing system that requests shared services from a server, and with which a user directly interacts. Examples of a client device include, but are not limited to, a workstation, a desktop computer, a computer terminal, a mobile computer, a laptop computer, a netbook computer, a tablet computer, a smart phone, a personal

digital assistant, a smart watch, smart glasses, a gaming device, a set-top box, a smart television and the like. Network infrastructure, such as routers, firewalls, switches, access points and the like, are not client devices as the term “client device” is defined herein. As defined herein, the term “user” means a person (i.e., a human being).

[0052] Remote server **304** is any computer system that serves at least some data and/or functionality to computer **301**. Remote server **304** may be controlled and used by the same entity that operates computer **301**. Remote server **304** represents the machine(s) that collect and store helpful and useful data for use by other computers, such as computer **301**. For example, in a hypothetical case where computer **301** is designed and programmed to provide a recommendation based on historical data, then this historical data may be provided to computer **301** from remote database **330** of remote server **304**. As defined herein, the term “server” means a data processing system configured to share services with one or more other data processing systems.

[0053] Public cloud **305** is any computer system available for use by multiple entities that provides on-demand availability of computer system resources and/or other computer capabilities, especially data storage (cloud storage) and computing power, without direct active management by the user. Cloud computing typically leverages sharing of resources to achieve coherence and economies of scale. The direct and active management of the computing resources of public cloud **305** is performed by the computer hardware and/or software of cloud orchestration module **341**. The computing resources provided by public cloud **305** are typically implemented by virtual computing environments that run on various computers making up the computers of host physical machine set **342**, which is the universe of physical computers in and/or available to public cloud **305**.

[0054] The virtual computing environments (VCEs) typically take the form of virtual machines from virtual machine set **343** and/or containers from container set **344**. It is understood that these VCEs may be stored as images and may be transferred among and between the various physical machine hosts, either as images or after instantiation of the VCE. Cloud orchestration module **341** manages the transfer and storage of images, deploys new instantiations of VCEs and manages active instantiations of VCE deployments. Gateway **340** is the collection of computer software, hardware, and firmware that allows public cloud **305** to communicate through WAN **302**.

[0055] VCEs can be stored as “images,” and a new active instance of the VCE can be instantiated from the image. Two familiar types of VCEs are virtual machines and containers. A container is a VCE that uses operating-system-level virtualization. This refers to an operating system feature in which the kernel allows the existence of multiple isolated user-space instances, called containers. These isolated user-space instances typically behave as real computers from the point of view of programs running in them. A computer program running on an ordinary operating system can utilize all resources of that computer, such as connected devices, files and folders, network shares, CPU power, and quantifiable hardware capabilities. However, programs running inside a container can only use the contents of the container and devices assigned to the container, a feature which is known as containerization.

[0056] Private cloud **306** is similar to public cloud **305**, except that the computing resources are only available for use by a single enterprise. While private cloud **306** is depicted as being in communication with WAN **302**, in other aspects, a private cloud **306** may be disconnected from the internet entirely (e.g., WAN **302**) and only accessible through a local/private network. A hybrid cloud is a composition of multiple clouds of different types (for example, private, community or public cloud types), often respectively implemented by different vendors. Each of the multiple clouds remains a separate and discrete entity, but the larger hybrid cloud architecture is bound together by standardized or proprietary technology that enables orchestration, management, and/or data/application portability between the multiple constituent clouds. In this aspect, public cloud **305** and private cloud **306** are both part of a larger hybrid cloud.

[0057] Various aspects of the present disclosure are described by narrative text, flowcharts, block diagrams of computer systems and/or block diagrams of the machine logic included in computer

program product (CPP) embodiments. With respect to any flowcharts, depending upon the technology involved, the operations can be performed in a different order than what is shown in a given flowchart. For example, again depending upon the technology involved, two operations shown in successive flowchart blocks may be performed in reverse order, as a single integrated step, concurrently, or in a manner at least partially overlapping in time.

[0058] As another example, two blocks shown in succession may, in fact, be accomplished as one step, executed concurrently, substantially concurrently, in a partially or wholly temporally overlapping manner, or the blocks may sometimes be executed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. It will also be noted that each block of the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, and combinations of blocks in the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, can be implemented by special purpose hardware-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts or carry out combinations of special purpose hardware and computer instructions. Each block in the flowchart or block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of instructions, which comprises one or more executable instructions for implementing the specified logical function(s).

[0059] The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only and is not intended to be limiting of the invention. As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “includes,” “including,” “comprises,” and/or “comprising,” when used in this disclosure, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, and/or groups thereof.

[0060] Reference throughout this disclosure to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “one arrangement,” “an arrangement,” “one aspect,” “an aspect,” or similar language means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment is included in at least one embodiment described within this disclosure. Thus, appearances of the phrases “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “one arrangement,” “an arrangement,” “one aspect,” “an aspect,” and similar language throughout this disclosure may, but do not necessarily, all refer to the same embodiment.

[0061] The term “plurality,” as used herein, is defined as two or more than two. The term “another,” as used herein, is defined as at least a second or more. The term “coupled,” as used herein, is defined as connected, whether directly without any intervening elements or indirectly with one or more intervening elements, unless otherwise indicated. Two elements also can be coupled mechanically, electrically, or communicatively linked through a communication channel, pathway, network, or system. The term “and/or” as used herein refers to and encompasses any and all possible combinations of one or more of the associated listed items. It will also be understood that, although the terms first, second, etc. may be used herein to describe various elements, these elements should not be limited by these terms, as these terms are only used to distinguish one element from another unless stated otherwise or the context indicates otherwise.

[0062] The term “if” may be construed to mean “when” or “upon” or “in response to determining” or “in response to detecting,” depending on the context. Similarly, the phrase “if it is determined” or “if [a stated condition or event] is detected” may be construed to mean “upon determining” or “in response to determining” or “upon detecting [the stated condition or event]” or “in response to detecting [the stated condition or event],” depending on the context. As used herein, the terms “if,” “when,” “upon,” “in response to,” and the like are not to be construed as indicating a particular operation is optional. Rather, use of these terms indicate that a particular operation is conditional. For example and by way of a hypothetical, the language of “performing operation A upon B” does not indicate that operation A is optional. Rather, this language indicates that operation A is conditioned upon B occurring.

[0063] The foregoing description is just an example of embodiments of the invention, and

variations and substitutions. While the disclosure concludes with claims defining novel features, it is believed that the various features described herein will be better understood from a consideration of the description in conjunction with the drawings. The process(es), machine(s), manufacture(s) and any variations thereof described within this disclosure are provided for purposes of illustration. Any specific structural and functional details described are not to be interpreted as limiting, but merely as a basis for the claims and as a representative basis for teaching one skilled in the art to variously employ the features described in virtually any appropriately detailed structure. Further, the terms and phrases used within this disclosure are not intended to be limiting, but rather to provide an understandable description of the features described.

Claims

1. A method, by an intelligent access control system, of implementing access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point, comprising: generating a security token; transmitting the security token to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user; causing the client module to pair with an access control device associated with the first user; causing the client module to transfer the security token to the access control device; monitoring a physical location of the client device within the controlled area; and determining, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated, wherein the client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the security token is regenerated and transmitted to the client module based upon the access control device being used at one of the at least one access point.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the transmitting includes transmitting a policy associated with the controlled area to the client module.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the determining is based upon a second user with a second client device being at least a certain distance away from the first client device, the first user is a controlling user, and the second user is a controlled user.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the determining is based upon a time in which the first user is within one of the plurality of access areas.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the policy is based upon one of the plurality of access areas in which the first user is located.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, from the client module, a request to opt into using the intelligent access control system.
8. An intelligent access control system configured to implement access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point, comprising: a hardware processor configured to perform the following executable operations: generating a security token; transmitting the security token to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user; causing the client module to pair with an access control device associated with the first user; causing the client module to transfer the security token to the access control device; monitoring a physical location of the client device within the controlled area; and determining, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated, wherein the client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.
9. The intelligent access control system of claim 8, wherein the security token is regenerated and transmitted to the client module based upon the access control device being used at one of the at least one access point.
10. The intelligent access control system of claim 8, wherein the transmitting includes transmitting a policy associated with the controlled area to the client module.
11. The intelligent access control system of claim 8, wherein the determining is based upon a

second user with a second client device being at least a certain distance away from the first client device, the first user is a controlling user, and the second user is a controlled user.

12. The intelligent access control system of claim 8, wherein the determining is based upon a time in which the first user is within one of the plurality of access areas.

13. The intelligent access control system of claim 8, wherein the policy is based upon one of the plurality of access areas in which the first user is located.

14. The intelligent access control system of claim 8, wherein the hardware processor configured to perform the following executable operation: receiving, from the client module, a request to opt into using the intelligent access control system.

15. A computer program product, comprising: a computer readable storage medium having stored therein program code for implementing access control to a controlled area having a plurality access areas divided by at least one access point, the program code, which when executed by an intelligent access control system, causes the intelligent access control system to perform: generating a security token; transmitting the security token to a client module executing on a client device associated with a first user; causing the client module to pair with an access control device associated with the first user; causing the client module to transfer the security token to the access control device; monitoring a physical location of the client device within the controlled area; and determining, by an access control system and based upon the physical location, that the first user is to be revalidated, wherein the client module causes, based upon the determining, the client device to generate an alert.

16. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the security token is regenerated and transmitted to the client module based upon the access control device being used at one of the at least one access point.

17. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the transmitting includes transmitting a policy associated with the controlled area to the client module.

18. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the determining is based upon a second user with a second client device being at least a certain distance away from the first client device, the first user is a controlling user, and the second user is a controlled user.

19. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the determining is based upon a time in which the first user is within one of the plurality of access areas.

20. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the policy is based upon one of the plurality of access areas in which the first user is located.
